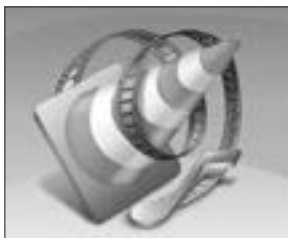


3.2 VLC Media Player

VLC Media Player contains many popular codecs in a standalone library. It is one of the most platform-independent players available, and has versions for Linux, Windows, Mac OS X, BeOS, BSD, Pocket PC, and Solaris.

VLC has the not-so-common ability to play video files from RAR archives. Also, it lets the user view the video content of incomplete video downloads, and it does this better than most other software do.

The codec pack built into VLC is so comprehensive that in cases such as Vorbis, DVD Video and DivX playback as well as parsers for the OGG and Matroska file formats, it is the only application that can play the video and audio files, without the need to download a separate codec pack. In some cases, it is the only player with native support on a system.



The VLC icon

Another interesting feature is the ability to access .iso files so you can play files on a disk image even if you don't have a disk image emulator installed, as is the case with most Windows setups.

We bundle the VLC Media Player in the Essentials section on our CD every month. To download it, visit www.videolan.org/vlc.

3.2.1 Configuring VLC

To open a file, go to File > Quick Open File. The Open File dialog box will appear. Select the file you wish to open, and select Open. VLC will start playing the selected file. An alternative is to drag and drop the file on the VLC main interface or playlist window from Explorer.